> in Moatize mine, one of the largest in the world. At the meeting, Lula tried unsuccessfully to convince her to reduce the requirement that Mozambicans make up 85% of the manpower employed in Vale's operations (Veja 2012, my translation).

Brazilian pressure to reduce Mozambican controls on foreign workers is not something new. A labour delegation from Canada and Brazil met with the Provincial Director of Labour in Tete Province in 2011 in the context of a tri-national worker exchange. We were told of Vale's constant pressure on Mozambican authorities to allow Vale to exceed the previously negotiated quotas on foreign workers. There was also pressure to give work permits to foreigners without sufficient skills to carry out the training component meant to be carried out by each foreign worker allowed a work permit.

The construction phase of the project included not only large numbers of Brazilian workers but also construction workers from the Philippines. Many of these were hired by Kentz Engineers and Contractors, a company which operates in nearly 30 countries and runs one of the world's biggest nickel-cobalt refineries in the world in Madagascar. In Mozambique, Kentz was subcontracted by Vale. Kentz employs more than 2500 overseas Filipino workers in its global operations. Many of the Filipinos working for Kentz in Madagascar were repatriated to the Philippines at the end of 2010. They filed cases before the Philippines Overseas Employment Administration (POEA) at the beginning of 2011, alleging unfair labour practices by Kentz. These included salary delays, overcrowded barracks, food shortages and inadequate health care (Bulatlat 2011).

On 18 November 2011, the Ministry of Labour in Mozambique announced problems involving Kentz and Filipino workers: 'The labour ministry has just expelled, with immediate effect, 115 foreign workers, mostly of South African and Filipino nationality, who were brought here illegally by the South African company Kentz Engineers & Constructors.' The company is a subcontractor of Brazilian mining giant Vale Moçambique, at the company's coal concessions in Moatize in the north-west of the country. Department inspectors found workers at the construction site who were denied workers' holidays or weekends and proper protective clothing. It also had not registered its Mozambican workers for social security. Kentz Engineers was fined close to 34 million meticals (R9.2 million) and granted 30 days to fix irregularities (*Mail & Guardian* 2011).

The workers based in Tete who participated in the international exchanges indicated that the operational phase of the coal mine today employs not only the quota maximum – or more – of Brazilian workers, but also many foreign workers,